

CHABAD OF PARKLAND

אתם נצבים היום כלכם

Atem Nitzovim Hayom Kulchem

Maamor — free translation & elucidation · Shabbos Parshas Nitzavim, Tishrei 5748 · bilti-mugah

⌘ MAAMOR

Alter Rebbe: Rabbi Shneur Zalman of Liadi, founder and first Rebbe of Chabad, 1745-1813. Author of Shulchan Oruch HoRav, and the Tanya. Delivered Maamorim that were then published in Likkutei Torah, Torah Or and Maamorei Admur Hazoken.

CONCEPT

Likkutei Torah: The work was published originally in two parts. The first part, Torah Or, was first printed in 5597 (1837) in Kopust, with Maamorim delivered by the Alter Rebbe, and transcribed by the Alter Rebbe's brother amongst others, most of them from 5556 (1796) through the end of 5572 (1812), covering the books of Bereishis and Shmos, with several

Our Parsha begins with a Possuk

אתם נצבים היום כלכם

“You are all standing this day”.

All Standing: All together the whole spectrum of the B'nei Yisroel from the exalted ranks of the chieftains of the tribes through to the lower ranks of the wood choppers and the water carriers.

The Alter Rebbe explains in Likkutei Torah at the beginning of our A Possuk: Devorim (29:9)

אתם נצבים היום כלכם לפני ה' אל קיכם ראשיכם שבטיכם זקניכם וש
טריכם כל אישי שר אל

“You are all standing this day before HaShem, your G-d the leaders of your tribes, your elders and your officers, every man of Israel”.

Maamorim on Shavuot and Pesach. The second half was published in Zhitomir in 5608 (1848) under the title Likkutei Torah, with Maamorim covering the books of Vayikra, Bamidbar and Devorim, Shir Hashirim, Yomim Tovim, Rosh Hashana & Yom Kipur. Our Parsha: Nitzovim. (Likkutei Torah Nitzovim) Because of its special relevance to Rosh Hashana, this week's Torah portion, "Nitzovim," is always read on the Shabbos preceding that holiday. This relevance is hinted at in the opening verses (Devorim 29:9-11): "You [the Jewish People] stand this day, all of you, before HaShem your G-d: [from] your heads of your tribes ... to the drawer of your water – that you may pass into the covenant of HaShem your G-d.." The expression "this day" (Hayom in Hebrew) alludes to Rosh Hashana, as we find it used in the liturgy, "This day [Rosh Hashana] marks the beginning of Your creation [of mankind and the universe], reminiscent of the First Day." Specifically, the Hebrew word used here for 'standing' Nitzovim connotes cohesion: on this day –

Parsha that this week's Parsha is always read prior to Rosh HaShonoh. This is alluded to in the word of the Rosh Hashana – the entire Jewish People (including every member of each of the ten spiritual categories that comprise the Jewish nation, which categories are alluded to in the verses quoted in the summary section above) stands united, as a single entity. By each individual realizing that, even if he or she is indeed a great person, there must be at least some small advantage which his or her fellow has over him or her, we all feel a greater bond between us – both in our daily lives, and on a more subtle level perceived by our souls. This bond of unity between us Jews is a prerequisite for HaShem in turn, in a similar bond, to unite with us on Rosh HaShonoh. On Rosh HaShonoh, HaShem reveals anew His sovereignty over us and we in turn proclaim ourselves His devoted subjects – renewing the purpose of Creation and bringing about the ideal unity between HaShem and Man. For a more detailed understanding of how to achieve this unity; also, the significance of repentance and why it is particularly appropriate on Rosh HaShonoh – we may take a clue from the next part of our verse: "that you may pass into the covenant of HaShem your G-d." The idea of a covenant (bris in Hebrew) is to cement a relationship between two parties, to create such a strong bond of unity as to defy intellectual definition, as to transcend logic. Two close friends, for instance, might establish a pact between- themselves to symbolize that their friendship will be eternal; even if they become separated or if one should eventually wrong the other – so that you would reasonably expect their friendship to terminate – remembrance of the pact ensures their continued relationship. In a similar fashion, and out of His great kindness towards us Jews, HaShem made with us a pact to stand by our relationship in times of strain: even if we transgress the will of HaShem, and one might reasonably expect Him to abandon us (Heaven forbid), HaShem remembers this covenant and has mercy upon us for its sake. Is always: Sometimes Vayeilech is read before Rosh HaShonoh and sometimes it is read after Rosh HaShonoh. Sometimes Nitzovim and Vayeilech are together and sometimes they are apart. But Nitzovim is always before Rosh HaShonoh. Also irrelevant of which day of the week Rosh HaShonoh falls. This: Connection between Parshas Nitzovim and Rosh HaShonoh.

Possuk – 'היום today' and this word alludes to Rosh HaShonoh. As the Talmudic maxim states:

This day is the beginning of Your works, a commemoration of the first day”.
The Alter Rebbe thus explains, א' that our Possuk

The Possuk: Our Possuk in this week's Parsha Nitzovim.

CONCEPT

Maxim states: in our Musof liturgy for Rosh HaShonoh we proclaim the maxim as quoted in Talmud (Rosh HaShonoh 27:1) where the Talmud states: Rav Shmuel bar Yitzhak said: In accordance with whose opinion do we pray today on Rosh HaShonoh, saying: 'היום תחלת-מעשי'.

אתם "נצבים היום

You are all standing this day,”

means that on this day of Rosh HaShonoh all the Neshomos of all of the B'nei Yisroel are all standing;[all the Neshomos] from “

ראשיכם שבתים

The leaders of your tribes”

א' through day.

CONCEPT

This day is the beginning of Your works, a commemoration of the first day? In accordance with whom? In accordance with the opinion of Rabbi Eliezer, who said: The world was created in the month of Tishrei. We therefore mention on Rosh HaShonoh that it is the first

First day: According to those that say the world was completed in Tishrei the first day of creation was on the 25th of Elul and on the sixth day of creation HaShem created man and that day is Rosh HaShonoh. Being that the world was created for mankind the first day is when Adam was created. א' Explains: According to the inner dimension through the understanding of Chassidus. ב' All standing: Together in absolute unity. ג' The leaders of the tribes: As in the people of stature, who have more exalted souls.

to Tthe “ ע ציך “your woodcutters”

עד ש אב מי מיך

and “your water drawers”.

UFurthermore, they are all standing in a manner that “

נ צ בים כ ל כם

All are standing unified together”, Uin absolute unity as one.

This Uis because on the day of Rosh HaShonoh all Neshomos Uascend to their highest source Uand there T'Trough to: As the next Possuk continues: (Devorim 29:10)

ט פ כם נ שי כם ו ג רך א שר ב ק רב מ ח ניך מ ח טב ע ציך עד “ ש אב מי מיך

our young children, your women, and your convert who is within your camp both your woodcutters and your water drawers”.

UWater drawers: The more simple folk who have lower souls. UTogether: On Rosh HaShonoh all Neshomos are standing together as one. UThis: The reason for this absolute unity to the extent that one can not differentiate or discern between the various different levels of Neshomos and people is..... UAll Neshomos: All the Neshomos both those that descend afterwards only a small descent and remain as lofty Neshomos and also those that descend a great descent from their supernal root to become very lowly Neshomos. In their source they are all exalted. UHighest source: In G-dliness as the Alter Rebbe writes in Tanya (Chapter 2)

ונפש השנית בישראל היא ה ממעל ממש

-“ חלק אלו “The second, uniquely Jewish, soul is truly “a part of HaShem above”.

There: As the Alter Rebbe writes in Tanya (Chapter 32) “Furthermore, they are actually all equal; and not only equal yet separate, but, furthermore, they all have one father — one source, and within their source they all comprise one entity. It is on account of this common

root in the One G-d that all of Israel are called “brothers” — in the full sense of the word, and not only figuratively, in the sense of “relatives” or “similar

they are all truly one.אכ To understand this conceptככof “

אתם נצבים היום

You are all standing this day”

from a deeper perspective, whereby the Possuk states thereafter:

לפני ה' אל קיכם

“Before HaShem your G-d”, not only can the word ל פני mean internally as in the word מיו פני that you are standing and connecting to HaShem your G-d through an internal connectionככas i

s explained elsewhereכד in appearance” and the like; only the bodies are distinct from each other.”אכ Truly one: As in one entity.ככ This concept: Of this absolute unity of the Neshomos of all of B'nei Yisroel on Rosh HaShono.כ Internal connection: On Rosh HaShono the Neshomos of the B'nei Yisroel are standing in an inner dimension of HaShem your Gd, in other words that their closeness and connection to Gdliness is deeper and in a more internal dimension of G-dliness.כד Explained elsewhere: In Chassidus. Torah Ohr (75:3) Ve'eileh Hamishpotim Asher Tossim Lifeneihem..... Lifeneihem means into their inner dimensions because knowledge is about drawing internally through which there is a revealed internal dimension of the Middos which is the vitality of the Middos It is explained in Parshas Mikeitz on the Possuk Vezos Lifnim Beyisroel that everyone has an internal dimension and an external dimension a hidden side and a revealed side and elsewhere it discusses wings how they are separate as in divided which is unlike Ufeneihem...

around the words of the Possukא להם משפטים

טים אשר כה “תשים לפנים

And these are the ordinancesכזthat you shall set

into them **כז** in an internal dimension, **כט** but also additionally,

ל פ ני ה' אל קי כם ל

these words can be interpreted to mean “in front of [before] HaShem your G-d”

as in higher [even] than the spiritual level of ‘HaShem your G-d’. **לא** This is also understood from what is written in an **כה** Words of the Possuk: (Shmos 21:1)

ו א לה ה מ ש פ טים א ש ר ת שים ל פ ני הם

“And these are the ordinances that you shall set before them”.

כז Are the ordinances: Laws of the Torah. **כז** You Shall set: That Moshe Rabeinu shall set.
כח Into them: Into the B’nei Yisroel. **כט** Internal dimension: In other words, Moshe Rabeinu shall not only teach the B’nei Yisroel the laws of the Torah, but he shall permeate them with the concepts of Torah into their deeper existence. Which in the case of our Possuk in our Parsha

א תם נ צ בים היום כ ל כם ל פ ני ה' “ אל קי כם

You are all standing this day before HaShem, your G-d”

that the B’nei Yisroel are standing still in the depths and most inner dimension of HaShem your G-d. Additionally: There is another explanation in the word **ל פ ני** from this Possuk, which is a more exalted and a great novelty beyond the previous explanation that **ל פ ני** means **פ ני מיו**. And that is... **לא** HaShem your G-d: In other words, the word **ל פ ני** means previously, higher and more exalted. This means that

ל פ ני ה' אל קי כם

means that the Neshomos of Yisroel are standing on Rosh HaShono in such exaltedness and closeness to G-dliness which is far greater than anything in G-dliness which is referred to as HaShem your G-d.

annotation in Likkutei Torah that quotes a correlation in Medrash Rabbah ^בל that says: “
^אל Regarding angels, the Possuk states: “

ש ר פים ע מ דים מ מ על לו לד

Seraphim-angels stood above Him”, and regarding Neshomos, the Possuk [similarly] states: “

א ת מ נ צ בים היום

You are all ^הל standing this day”.

^בל Medrash Rabbah: Is the largest collection of Aggadic Medroshim mostly from the time of the Amoraim (200 - 500 CE) and speaks about a wide variety of subjects and usually contains stories and legends and is generally concerned with ethical teachings or other topical issues. Unlike Halachic Medroshim that are concerned with the legal aspects and implications of texts in Tanach. ^אל That says: (Shmos Rabbah 15:6) Just as everyone fears HaShem and the angels, so too the gentiles fear the B’nei Yisroel as the Possuk states: (Devorim:10) “Then all the peoples of the earth will see that the name of the Lord is called upon you, and they will fear you“. This is the meaning of the words (Shir HaShirim 6:4)

אי מה כ נ ד ג לות

“Awesome as the bannered legions”

That HaShem compares the B’nei Yisroel to the angels. As we see about the angels the Possuk says (Yeshaya 6:2) “Seraphim angels stood above Him” and about the B’nei Yisroel the Possuk says: (Devorim 29:9) “You are all standing this day”. The Angels say every day Holy, Holy, Holy and Yisroel says G-d of Avrohom, G-d of Yitzchok and G-d of Yaakov... This is why it says “

אי מה כ נ ד ג לות

Awesome as the bannered legions”.

^דל Possuk states: Yeshaya (6:2)

ש ר פים ע מ דים מ מ על לו שש כ נ פ ים שש כ נ פ ים ל א חד ב ש ת ים י כ סה פ
ניו

I

ב ש ת ים י כ סה ר ג ליו

“I

ב ש ת ים יעו פף

Seraphim-angels stood above Him, six wings, six wings to each one; with two he would cover his face, and with two he would cover his feet, and with two he would fly”.

להAll Standing: All together the whole spectrum of the B’nei Yisroel from the exalted ranks of the chieftains of the tribes through to the lower ranks of the wood choppers and the water carriers.

See what is written in Chassidus on this topic 17of

ש ר פים “ ע מ דים מ מ על לו

Seraphim-angels 17stood above Him”, חלin connection with the explanation 18on the Possuk: “

ו נ ק ד ש תי בתוך ב נ י ש ר אל

I shall be sanctified amidst the B’nei Yisroel”.

Accordingly, the concept of: “

You are all

17 This topic: Where Chassidus explains the Possuk in the prophesy of Yeshaya that describes HaShem's supernal chariot. (Likkutei Torah Emor 32:2) for the full text see footnote (1027) at end of Maamor. 17 Seraphim-angels: The Rambam explains (Yesodei HaTorah 2:7) that all angels fall under one of ten ranks. Namely: Chayot Hakodesh, Ophanim, Erelim, Chashmalim, Seraphim, Malachim, Elokim, Bene Elokim, Cheruvim, and Ishim. These ranks refer to the degree of the angel's comprehension of HaShem; some have a greater understanding of HaShem and His ways than others. Zohar (II, 43a) has a slightly different list: Malachim, Erelim, Seraphim, Chayot, Ophanim, Chashmalim, Elim, Elokim, B'nei Elokim, and Ishim. In Kabbalah, the seraphim are the higher angels of the World of Beriah (Creation), whose understanding of their distance from the HaShem's infinite light causes their continual "burning up" in self-nullification. Through this they ascend higher and return to their place. Below them in the World of Yetzirah (Formation) are the Chayos angels of Yechezkel's vision, who serve HaShem with self-aware instinctive emotions. 17 Above him: Above HaShem who sits on the high and elevated throne so to speak. 17 explanation: Chassidus Uses the Possuk

שרפים עומדים מעל לו

to explain the meaning of the following Possuk in a Maamor with the opening verse:

ונקדשתי בתוך בני ישראל

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Possuk: (Vayikra 22:32) ולא תחללו

את שם קדשי ונקדשתי בתוך בני ישראל אני "ה' מקדשכם

You shall not desecrate My Holy Name.

I shall be sanctified amidst the B'nei Yisroel. I am HaShem Who sanctifies you,"

standing this day" will be understood. 17 This is the extent of the annotation. 17 From here it is understood that just as the standing position of the Seraphim-angels is מעל לו above the position of the supernal Man who is on the throne, 17 [this is similar to the discussion

which is explained elsewhere regarding these Seraphim-angels and how they are able to ascend so high. Is it because of their Avodah in Machshova or through their Avodah in Machshova? Will be understood: From here we should understand that this Possuk is alluding to the fact that the B'nei Yisroel have the ability to stand higher than the level of HaShem as it is expressed in this Possuk. Extant of the annotation: In the Maamor Atem Nitzovim on page 44:1. Supernal man: This alludes to HaShem Himself. On the throne: As in the earlier Possuk (Yeshayayohu 6:1)

בשנתמותה מלך עזיה

I

ואר אה אתה'י שב עלי' כסא רם " ונשא וש

I

ליו מל אים אתה הי כל

In the

year of the death of King Uzziah, I saw HaShem sitting on a high and exalted throne, and His lower extremity filled the Temple". Elsewhere: In Likkutei Torah (Emor 32:2) There are two different reasons why the Seraphim angels burn up. Avoda in Machshova: one reason why the Seraphim burn up is because they have such a burning passionate desire and yearn to ascend and feed off a higher vitality source that they burn up from their own Machshova.

calling each other and saying?...] similarly, in our situation of “

אתם נצבים היום לפני ה

You are standing this day in front of (before) HaShem”

” it can also be understood to mean standing above [even] the level of ‘the name of HaShem’. This can also be understood from the continuation in the Maamor, from where it explains the Neshoma’s Avodah of Rosh HaShonoh is the coronation and inauguration of HaKodosh Boruch Hu as King as the Avodah in calling each other: When they say Kodosh they ascend too high spiritually and they burn up. Elsewhere in Likkutei Torah the

Alter Rebbe explains that because they burn up when they say Kodosh they don't last long enough to say Kodosh Kodosh Kodosh so they call to each other so that between them they can say Kodosh Kodosh Kodosh as we say in 'Uvo'oh Letzion'!

מ ק ב לין דין מ דין ו א מ רין ק דיש " ב ש מי מרו מא

They receive one from

the other and proclaim Kodosh in the supernal heavens" because alone they just expire.

מ Above the level of the name of HaShem: Obviously not above HaShem Himself but above HaShem's name which is a lower Divine representation than HaShem Himself but still holy as we say in davening:

א תה קדוש וש מך קדוש

"You are holy and Your name is also holy".

מ Coronation of Hakodosh Boruch

Talmud states: "you will coronate Me as King over you". [The implication is] that from the fact itself that the B'nei Yisroel have the power and ability to coronate HaKodosh Boruch Hu as a King and to make HaShem become King over them and over the world it is [self] understood that their status is [from] above this level. נב This is so because even though before this נג HaShem Hu as King: Afresh. As the words of the Talmud that through the sound of the Shofar and as a result of the verses of kingship, remembrances and Shofars in the Musaf prayer on Rosh HaShonoh. Coronate Me as king over you: As the Talmud (Rosh HaShonoh 16a) states: And for what reason did the Torah say: Pour water onto the Mizbei'ach in the Beis Hamikdosh on Succos? HaKodosh Boruch Hu said: Pour water before Me on the festival of Succos so that the rains of the year, which begin to fall after Succos, will be blessed for you. And recite before Me on Rosh HaShonoh verses that mention מלכיות - Kingships, זכרונות Remembrances, ושופרות and Shofros: Kingships so that you will crown Me as King over you; Remembrances so that your remembrance will rise before Me for good; and with what will the remembrance rise? It will rise with the shofar. Again in Talmud Rosh HaShonoh 34b the Talmud asks What is the reason that all the blasts and blessings are indispensable on Rosh HaShana? Rabba said that HaKodosh Boruch Hu said: Recite before Me נא That their status: The B'nei Yisroel's status. נב Above this level: Of Malchus which is how come that they have this ability to coronate HaShem as King and renew HaShem's sovereignty over the world. נג Before this: Before the B'nei Yisroel coronate HaShem anew.

already had a desire for kingship, nevertheless this desire נד is only in a state referred to as 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' נה which is an undeveloped desire within His essence נ and is not [yet] within a parameter of revelation. נ This is because if this 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' were in a revealed sense, there would be no novelty or such fanfare in relation to Rosh HaShonoh. נ Therefore the fact itself that there is a fanfare in relation to Rosh נ This desire: Although it is true that HaShem just has to want something and it becomes a reality in the upper spheres. Nevertheless, it does not come into reality in a revealed sense. In a Maamor on Pirkei Ovot (5:1) regarding the Mishna that says

בעשרה מאמרות נב רא

ו מה תלמו לו מר ,

לם HaShem created the world with ten utterances The Rebbe explains the difference between creating a potential and creating in our reality. נה Rotzon Hamuchlot: This concept is explained at length in Chassidus in Maamorim pertaining to Rosh HaShonoh. Rotzon HaMuchlot is the initial desire for something although it is only theoretical so to speak. For a full explanation see footnote (103ג7). נ His essence: It remains in HaShem's essence. נ Revelation: But remains as a concealed Rotzon. נ Rosh HaShonoh: And Rosh HaShonoh would just be a celebration of an old idea, as opposed to now we coronate HaShem as king anew.

HaShonoh, נ attests [to the inference] that the Hamshocha of HaShem's Rotzon נ is something new. From this it is understood that 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' is not within the parameter of revelation at all. נ We can add further, that this supernal 'Rotzon Muchlot' is not even revealed to itself, נ just as is explained in the concept of 'Reisha Deloh Issyadah' נ - a 'Beginning which נ Rosh HaShonoh: All the commotion in the coronation of HaShem as King of Kings on Rosh HaShonoh. Hamshocha: That the B'nei Yisroel elicit and renew on Rosh HaShonoh. נ HaShem's Rotzon: Bringing this dormant Rotzon into revelation. נ Revelation at all: And the revelation is only renewed at a much later stage called 'Rotzon hagolui'. נ Revealed to itself: In other words, it is so concealed and hidden that it is not even possible for it to come out into revelation or active kingship. נ Reisha Deloh Issyadah: A beginning which is unknown. Sometimes called by its abbreviation 'Radloh'. Is a very lofty level in G-dliness, part of the 'Makif Kloli' – the general encompassing energy, and it never comes into revelation, and only in the future with the coming of Moshiach will it be revealed. It is the inner dimension of a Divine face called 'Atik Yomin' – ancient days, which is the inner dimension of 'Kesser' and it is not even a source for emanations. It is explained in kabbalah and in Chassidus that the intellectual attributes of 'Chochmah, Binah and Da'as' of the supernal Sefiros from whence the Middos come are called the

is unknown' - that it is a beginning which does not know and is unknown, because it is not even in the realm of knowledge or revelation for itself, נ meaning that it does not know itself what it has. From this it is understood, that since the B'nei Yisroel are able to cause this

revelation in HaShem's 'Rotzon' to materialise this, attests [to the fact] that they are actually rooted in 'Rotzon Hamuchlot'. **י** three heads. However there is a higher and greater level than the intellectual attributes that is beyond serving as a root to emit Middos, it is a Divine level which is separated and absolutely exalted from the existence of the world to the extent that it is too lofty to even be a root to the Divine light that allows for the existence of the world which is the supernal Middos. This is the Divine light of the 'Ein Sof' which transcends any worldly existence and is the root for the three heads. This is what is explained that the Reisha Deloh Issyadah is the highest state within the three heads. It is concealed and completely covered up and has no connection to anything else. **ס** For itself: Not only is it unknown to others it is even unknown to itself. **י** Rotzon HaMuchlot: For if not they would not have the ability to reveal this Rotzon.

לזכות אילנה רפאילה בת שרה לרפואה שלימה וקרובה

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It can also be said **י** that the B'nei Yisroel **נ** are even spiritually higher than this state of 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' itself **ט** because 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' itself has no revelation; as previously mentioned. The fact that the B'nei Yisroel are able to cause a revelation within it, in other words they can effectuate a change within it so to speak **א** attests to the fact that their root **ב** is spiritually higher than the 'Rotzon Hamuchlot'. Because the 'Rotzon' is not the essence **ז** **ע** It can also be said: A very big Chiddush - novelty. **ס** The B'nei Yisroel: From the perspective of their Neshomoh and from the perspective of their ability to arouse the supernal will to become King on Rosh HaShonoh. **ט** Itself: And the Neshomos of Yisroel are rooted in an even higher Divine level of G-dliness. Previously mentioned: That this Rotzon is concealed and covered up completely without any chance of revelation to anything else or to influence anything else at all. **א** Effectuate change so to speak: In comparison to its own previous plans, and they cause that it shall arouse and reveal itself. **ב** Their root: The root of the Neshomos of B'nei Yisroel. **ג** The essence: Just as it is with a person that even though his Rotzon

whereas their root **ד** is in HaShem's very essence and being Blessed be He, and it is there that this 'Rotzon HaMuchlot' is formed. **ה** Furthermore, **ו** the root of the B'nei Yisroel is even higher **ז** than this concept of HaShem's essence and being, for the description of 'HaShem's essence and being' is itself a specific description. The basis of this description **ח** is the negation of all revelations lower **ט** is a exalted faculty and a general faculty, is not the essence of the person himself but one of its faculties. **י** Their root: The root of the Neshomos of B'nei Yisroel. **י** Is formed: And from here the Neshomos of the B'nei Yisroel have the impetus to effect change in HaShem's Rotzon Hamuchlot. **י** Furthermore: An even bigger Chidush. **י** Even higher: Deeper and higher. **י** This description: HaShem's essence and being. **ט** Lower than it: In other words, by highlighting that we are talking about HaShem's very essence, which transcends any sort of revelation, ray or extension which are not His

essence, automatically anything which one has to say about HaShem is not going to be his essence and therefore is negated from the discussion because we are discussing HaShem's very essence. However, HaShem's essence is beyond any sort of description and therefore the title itself of HaShem's essence and being is in fact a description and not His essence. Dedicated in the merit of

מרת רעכיל צפרה בת מלכה שתחי

for a complete & speedy recovery P a g e 17

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than it; and from this itself it is understood that it has **אפ** an association and connection to all the levels that it negates. **בפ** This is in [stark] contrast to that which is explained in the Tanya **גפ** that if someone says that he This itself: From this fact that we can and need to clarify and to negate that this description is not actually HaShem's essence itself. **דפ** That it has: That the essence of this description has... **הפ** It negates: Because if it did not have any association or connection to these aspects of revelation and illumination at all, there would be no place and no reason or need to emphasise that it is not those things. **וה** In the Tanya: In Shaar Hayichud Veho'emunah chapter nine the Alter Rebbe writes: HaShem is "high and exalted" and very greatly elevated above the level of wisdom, and it is not at all appropriate to ascribe to Him anything that pertains to wisdom, even in a very lofty and sublime form, i.e., even if by doing so we mean to express how He transcends wisdom; for example, to say of Him that it is beyond the capacity of any higher or lower creature to comprehend His wisdom or His Essence. Even this negative reference to wisdom is inappropriate, - For comprehension pertains and applies to a matter of wisdom and intellect, about which one can say that it can or cannot be understood because of the profundity of the concept. However, concerning HaKodosh Boruch Hu, who transcends intellect and wisdom, it is not at all appropriate to say that one cannot comprehend Him because of the profundity of the concept, for He is not within the realm of comprehension at all. He who states that it is impossible to comprehend Him, is like one who says of some lofty and profound concept that it cannot be touched with the hands because of the depth of the concept. Whoever hears [this] will mock him, because the sense of touch refers and applies only to physical objects, which may be grasped by the hands. Exactly so, the level of intellect and comprehension in relation to the Holy One, blessed be He, is considered as actual physical action.

cannot feel a deep intellectual concept **זפ** with his hands people would laugh at him. **חפ** The root of the B'nei Yisroel is as the Possuk states

the word ל פ ני over here would mean before פ as in greater than any levels related to the name of Havaya.

Even greater than any parameter or description of levels פ and of 'up' or 'down' or in 'front' or פ Intellectual concept: Which requires the tools of one's cognitive and cerebral faculties to comprehend not one's touch of one's hands. פ Laugh at him: Because there are things that can be compared to one another because they have some common ground and then there are things which cannot because they don't have any common ground. Just as intellect and touch are not on the same barometer so too HaShem's essence and any sort of description are not on the same barometer פ Before: Chassidus explains that whilst in our world we have a concept of time and space and therefore the concepts of before and after are either related to the timeline or to spatial proximity in the higher realms time and space do not exist so every time that the term before is used it relates to a higher spiritual plane than something which comes after. So when the Possuk states

ל פ ני ה' אל קי כם

which we would normally translate as before HaShem your Gd, in an environment where there is no time and space which is the environment from where our souls descend that means spiritually higher than G-d your G-d.

פ Description of levels: Whichever levels they may be.

'behind'... פ From all this it is understood; also, in the manner of the Avodah of the B'nei Yisroel (that they are

נ צ בים ל פ ני ה

“Standing before HaShem, your G-d”

”) פ that the Avodah should be in a manner of unity where everyone is united as one; as previously mentioned. צ For as a result of this צ we can reach

ל פ ני ה' אל קי כם

which is higher than all other levels.

Similarly with unity **אג** which is **אד** a point beyond all differences in levels **הצ** and **פח** Or behind: In other words, completely detached from any description which relates to any dimension or level upper or lower, and that is where the Neshomos elevate to and stand on Rosh HaShonoh. **טפ** Your G-d: According to all the Pirushim mentioned earlier including the exalted Pirush in 'Lifenei' greater than any description or definition. The Avodah: Of the Neshomos of B'nei Yisroel on Rosh HaShonoh. **אצ** Previously mentioned: And as outlined earlier how incredibly deep this unity can reach. **בצ** Result of this: In the power of this achievement of uniting as one. **גצ** With unity: Which brings the Neshomos and causes them to elevate in this state. **דצ** Which is: Unity on an incredibly high level. **הצ** In levels: Not only is there unity

even beyond any parameter of differences in levels **אצ** from “

רא שי כם ש ב טי כם

The leaders of your tribes”

through to **ע ציך** **טב** **ח** your “woodcutters”

עד ש אב מי מיך

and your “water drawers”

all becomes one individual point which is greater than any boundaries of division. From this **אצ** is extended **אצ** thereafter **טצ** in all the details as they are in their place that the unity extends to the whole of B'nei Yisroel **אק** From “

רא שי כם ש ב טי כם

The leaders of your tribes”

through to

ח טב ע ציך עד ש אב מי מיך

across different levels or even unity to the extent that there are no longer differences in levels, because all differences no longer exist. **אצ** Parameter ... in levels: Where there are no definitions at all and automatically there are no differences at all. **אצ** From this: Absolute unity until there

is only one individual point in which all Neshomos of Yisroel when they elevate in front of HaShem your G-d higher than any other states or levels as is expressed earlier. **נצח** Is extended: And descends and reveals. **טצ** Thereafter: his concept of unity. In their place: Although in their place wherever that might be there are differences and there are differences in the levels even there too there is an absolute unity. **אָב'nei Yisroel**: in all the individual levels.

“your woodcutters and your water drawers”. **בָּבָב** This footnote is the continuation from footnote (3617). This topic Where Chassidus explains the Possuk in the prophesy of Yeshaya that describes HaShem’s supernal chariot. (Likkutei Torah Emor 32:2) In a Maamor with the opening words

וְנִקְדָּשׁ תִּי בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

in the fifth chapter the Alter Rebbe discusses the group of angels called Seraphim that say ‘Kodosh’

and explains that they are from the world of Briyah where ChaBa”D is Revealed because the angels and the souls are able to grasp the greatness of the Ein Sof blessed be He. He then talks about the vitality in Memaleh Kol Almin – the vitalising force that fills the worlds which is sub divided into three which are the upper Gan Eden, the lower Gan Eden and this world; analogous to a head, body and feet. All the Divine comprehension of HaShem’s greatness in the upper worlds and in the lower worlds comes from Memaleh Kol Olmin, however HaShem Himself is holy, separated, beyond comprehension ... and the vitality which HaShem vitalises them with does not go through the contractions and is called Sovev Kol Olmin – the vitalising Divine energy that does not pervade anything and cannot permeate anything it can only encompass from outside. Through these angels’ contemplation and grasp in this they become excited with a burning yearning desire like a flaming fire to look at HaShem’s very glory in the state of Sovev Kol Olmin which is holy and separated and that is why they are called Seraphim because of the burning yearning like a flaming fire and the incredible passion to become incorporated within Sovev Kol Olmin ... and that is why the Possuk states:

שֶׁרָפִים עֹמְדִים מֵעַל לוֹ

“Seraphim-angels stood above Him.

Earlier the question was asked how can one say about a created being that he stands above HaShem? The answer is that when Yeshaya says: “he sees HaShem sitting on a high and elevated throne etc and Seraphim are standing above Him” he makes mention of the name Adnus’ this name symbolises the level of Kingship as the way in which it pervades the worlds within the vitality of Memaleh Kol Olmin ... through severities and contractions to first

reduce and contract the intense light and vitality so that it could pervade the worlds and that it should be of limited form... and above this contracted level of kingship coming from the name Adnus' the Possuk continues and "the Seraphim angels are standing above Him" in other words that they are higher than the name Adnus'

אז which is Memaleh Kol Olmin. This is because they are yearning with a burning Desire to leave their own confines and to become incorporated within Sovev Kol Olmin which is called holy. So in other words, because they are constantly wanting and yearning to leave the confines of their own vitality which is Memaleh Kol Olmin through the name Adnus' and they are passionately wanting to leave that source of vitality and they want to ascend up to the higher level and be vitalised by Sovev Kol Olmin as the maxim 'where someone wants to be that is where he is' (Or 'where someone thoughts are that is where he is') and they want to be higher than Adnus' so they are standing higher. אז This footnote pertains to footnote (55נה) Rotzon Hamuchlot: This concept is explained at length in Chassidus in Maamorim pertaining to Rosh HaShonoh. There are three stages to wanting something, starting with a natural inbuilt want that one has but does not feel it or might not even realise that he has this want, like for example the want to have a home which as a human being means that he has to have a home where to live but he has not thought about this want and does not feel it. Or he might feel it and have thought a little about it but has pushed the thought away to a time when he will have resources or time to think further and make a plan. This is called in Chassidus a 'Rotzon Hamuchlot'. Then there is a second stage of want when through internal discussions one realises what it is that he wants but has not expressed it in anyway, so it is revealed to himself but not further to anyone else and no action has come from it. This in Chassidus is called 'Rotzon Hakodum' 'An early want'. But then through communication and action this 'want' comes into revelation and action. In Chassidus this is called 'Rotzon Golui' a revealed want. Similarly, the first stage in HaShem's supernal Rotzon – 'want' for kingdom is called 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' which refers only to a decision to want but not a revealed desire. To further understand this there is a parable brought of a man who wants to build a house. Before he builds the house he must 'want' to build a house. In order to be motivated to actually do something about it and make it happen he then needs to develop that 'want' into a revealed desire. The cause that inspires the revealed desire is the silent want called the 'Rotzon HaMuchlot' the resolution to one day want. This resolution is not a revealed want and does not bring on any action but it is a want that remains undeveloped in Machshova. On the other hand although this 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' is not constructive in any way it is the main reason why this want

eventually makes it to become a 'Rotzon Golui' a revealed want. So too in the analogue with regards to G-dliness so to speak. Before arousing a new revealed Divine 'want' to rule over the world and created beings as King, there is a 'Rotzon Muchlot' which is a 'Rotzon' in 'Machshova' but does not follow through into action, but it does become a reason for a revealed 'Rotzon'. This explains our Maamor that although before the 'Rotzon Golui' there already was a 'Rotzon Hamuchlot' it is dormant and does not trigger a renewed kingship nor any new influence to the worlds.